SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

31 May 2022 · Shift 1

83 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 17 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 24 questions

Q.1

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them contains a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error. He continued staring at the elephant, as if he had not see one before.

(A) as if he had not see
(B) staring at the elephant
(C) one before
(D) He continued

Q.2

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. A visit “in” Ladhak is a must these days.

(A) from
(B) to
(C) for
(D) at

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The NCERT “was set up ahead” by the government to assist and advise the Central and State Governments on policies and programmes for qualitative improvement in school education.

(A) was set off
(B) was set forward
(C) was set over
(D) was set up

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option fill in the blank. I have been studying this course _____ two years now.

(A) through
(B) since
(C) for
(D) almost

Q.5

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Incite

(A) Pacify
(B) Tighten
(C) Inflame
(D) Quote

Q.6

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice This match is being watched today by more than thirty-three million people worldwide.

(A) This match is watching more than thirty-three million people worldwide today.
(B) More than thirty-three million people worldwide have been watching this match today.
(C) More than thirty-three million people worldwide are watching this match today.
(D) Today more than thirty-three million people worldwide have watched this match.

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Sum and substance

(A) Essence
(B) Difficulty
(C) Deliberation
(D) Assessment

Q.8

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A.The current concern is that it is rising day by day due to various resources of pollutants. B.It has been there in different forms since a long time, even before human evolution, such as volcanic eruptions, wildfire which led to various photochemical reactions in the atmosphere. C.Pollution has become a very common yet serious issue in today's world. D.And, one of the main pollutants are humans and man-made machines.

(A) CBAD
(B) ABCD
(C) CDBA
(D) CADB

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Under duress

(A) Under pressure
(B) Under shelter
(C) Under confusions
(D) Under support

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Apple of one's eye

(A) Very dear
(B) Very harmful
(C) Very useful
(D) Very far

Q.11

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Direct and outspoken

(A) Forthright
(B) Fortitude
(C) Formica
(D) Fortify

Q.13

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Pretence

(A) Reality
(B) Impotence
(C) Arrogance
(D) Intolerance

Q.14

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Repitetion
(B) Portray
(C) Procedure
(D) Separate

Q.15

Spot the error in the given sentence and select the correct sentence from the options given. Is Savita is joining us for lunch today?

(A) Is Savita joining us for lunch today?
(B) Savita is joined us for lunch today?
(C) Savita joining us for lunch today?
(D) Are Savita joining us for lunch today?

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Precocious

(A) Liberal
(B) Gentle
(C) Backward
(D) Lenient

Q.17

Complete the collocation. I met my professor yesterday and we _____ a long conversation about books and work.

(A) did
(B) spoke
(C) had
(D) talked

Q.18

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Fleck

(A) Spot
(B) Neglect
(C) View
(D) Fault

Q.19

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. The finance minister will announce the budget.

(A) The budget will have announced by the finance minister.
(B) The budget were announced by the finance minister.
(C) The budget are announced by the finance minister.
(D) The budget will be announced by the finance minister.

Q.20

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Allowing or assisting to discover

(A) Conceptual
(B) Ineducative
(C) Unempirical
(D) Heuristic

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The most urgent areas of attention and immediate action are nutrition, health and education of children, whose well-being (1)_____ the health of the society and caring outlook of the polity. Since the causes of malnutrition of children are many, like exploding population, (2)_____ against the female child, weak and suffering mothers, the remedy calls for ‘care of the mother and care by mother’,(3)_____, an effective control over population explosion. Ignorance on what food should be taken is another (4)_____ factor that results in malnutrition among women and children. The implementation of various schemes to fight the (5)_____ of malnutrition and undernourishment of children requires planning, co-ordination and monitoring by high-powered bodies right down to the village level.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) reflects
(B) thinks
(C) groups
(D) efforts

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The most urgent areas of attention and immediate action are nutrition, health and education of children, whose well-being (1)_____ the health of the society and caring outlook of the polity. Since the causes of malnutrition of children are many, like exploding population, (2)_____ against the female child, weak and suffering mothers, the remedy calls for 'care of the mother and care by mother',(3)_____, an effective control over population explosion. Ignorance on what food should be taken is another (4)_____ factor that results in malnutrition among women and children. The implementation of various schemes to fight the (5)_____ of malnutrition and undernourishment of children requires planning, co-ordination and monitoring by high-powered bodies right down to the village level.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) bias
(B) advanced
(C) neutral
(D) law

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The most urgent areas of attention and immediate action are nutrition, health and education of children, whose well-being (1)_____ the health of the society and caring outlook of the polity. Since the causes of malnutrition of children are many, like exploding population, (2)_____ against the female child, weak and suffering mothers, the remedy calls for 'care of the mother and care by mother',(3)_____, an effective control over population explosion. Ignorance on what food should be taken is another (4)_____ factor that results in malnutrition among women and children. The implementation of various schemes to fight the (5)_____ of malnutrition and undernourishment of children requires planning, co-ordination and monitoring by high-powered bodies right down to the village level.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) Regardless
(B) Against
(C) Instead
(D) Besides

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The most urgent areas of attention and immediate action are nutrition, health and education of children, whose well-being (1)_____ the health of the society and caring outlook of the polity. Since the causes of malnutrition of children are many, like exploding population, (2)_____ against the female child, weak and suffering mothers, the remedy calls for 'care of the mother and care by mother',(3)_____, an effective control over population explosion. Ignorance on what food should be taken is another (4)_____ factor that results in malnutrition among women and children. The implementation of various schemes to fight the (5)_____ of malnutrition and undernourishment of children requires planning, co-ordination and monitoring by high-powered bodies right down to the village level.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) advisory
(B) explanatory
(C) contradictory
(D) contributory

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The most urgent areas of attention and immediate action are nutrition, health and education of children, whose well-being (1)_____ the health of the society and caring outlook of the polity. Since the causes of malnutrition of children are many, like exploding population, (2)_____ against the female child, weak and suffering mothers, the remedy calls for 'care of the mother and care by mother',(3)_____, an effective control over population explosion. Ignorance on what food should be taken is another (4)_____ factor that results in malnutrition among women and children. The implementation of various schemes to fight the (5)_____ of malnutrition and undernourishment of children requires planning, co-ordination and monitoring by high-powered bodies right down to the village level.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) menace
(B) solace
(C) balance
(D) embrace

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.1

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 176, 218, 228, 291, 280, 364, 332, ?

(A) 435
(B) 416
(C) 437
(D) 384

Q.2

The second number in the given number-pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) is/are followed in all the number-pairs, except one. Find that odd number-pair.

(A) 48:7
(B) 25:8
(C) 15:4
(D) 8:3

Q.3

Which letter cluster will replace the question mark(?) to complete the given series? EMXB, ?, YGRV, VDOS, SALP

(A) BYJU
(B) JBUY
(C) YUBJ
(D) BJUY

Q.4

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 24*6*51*31*3

(A) =,−,×,+
(B) ×,−,=,×
(C) −,÷,=,+
(D) +,−,=,×

Q.6

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the sixth term is related to the fifth term. 5 : 35 :: 9 : ? :: 14 : 224

(A) 99
(B) 113
(C) 107
(D) 87

Q.8

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1. Knight 2. Kitchen 3. Kinship 4. Kinetic 5. Kind

(A) 5,4,3,2,1
(B) 5,3,4,2,1
(C) 5,3,2,4,1
(D) 5,2,3,4,1

Q.9

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 7 : 71::13 : 209::16 : ?

(A) 291
(B) 317
(C) 305
(D) 309

Q.10

In a certain code language, “NOPE” is coded as “100”, and “EGG” is coded as “38”. How will “LAP” be coded in that language?

(A) 27
(B) 31
(C) 29
(D) 58

Q.11

In a certain code language, 'STATE' is written as '38401405' and 'EXILE' is written as 5489245'. How will ‘ARENA’ be written in that language?

(A) 21810142
(B) 1365281
(C) 21181014
(D) 1365141

Q.12

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. BIRTHDAY : HDAYBIRT :: CHILDREN : DRENCHIL :: PROGRESS : ?

(A) SSERGORP
(B) RPOGERSS
(C) GRESSPRO
(D) RESSPROG

Q.13

Three Statements are given followed by Three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All huts are houses. No villa is a house. Some buildings are villas. Conclusions: I. Some buildings are huts. II. Some houses are buildings. III. No hut is a villa.

(A) Only conclusion III follow.
(B) Only conclusion II follows.
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(D) Only conclusion I follows.

Q.14

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 5, 16, 28, 36, 71, 90, 234, 342, ?

(A) 739
(B) 793
(C) 893
(D) 839

Q.15

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 16*2*4*8*10*34

(A) −,+,×,÷,=
(B) ÷,×,+,−, =
(C) ÷,×,−,+, =
(D) ×, ÷,−,+, =

Q.18

Select the option that represents the letters that, when sequentially placed from left to right in the blanks below, will complete the letter series. t u _ _ x _ _ _ u u_ _ x y _ _ _ v x x _

(A) u v x y u v x t u u y
(B) u v x x t v x t u u y
(C) u v x y t v x t u u y
(D) u v x y t v x t u u u

Q.19

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation 104*26*13*7*18*77

(A) ×, +, ÷, −, =
(B) ÷, +, ×, −, =
(C) ÷, −, ×, +, =
(D) ×, +, −, ÷, =

Q.20

In a certain code language, 'THREE' is written as 'UISFF', and 'SEVEN' is written as 'TFWFO'. How will 'EIGHT' be written in that language?

(A) JFHIU
(B) FJHIU
(C) FJHUI
(D) JFIHU

Q.21

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 58,117,237,479,965,?

(A) 1939
(B) 1930
(C) 1929
(D) 1940

Q.25

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 12, 32,123,609,?

(A) 3654
(B) 3054
(C) 3045
(D) 3647

Quantitative Aptitude 16 questions

Q.1

A train crosses a 400 m-long platform in 50 seconds. It crosses another 600 m-long platform in 60 seconds. What are the length and the speed of the train?

(A) 600 m; 72 km/h
(B) 550 m; 75 km/h
(C) 500 m; 70 km/h
(D) 650 m; 74 km/h

Q.3

The curved surface area of a hemisphere is 1232 cm^2. Its radius will be: (Take $\pi=22/7$)

(A) 12 cm
(B) 14 cm
(C) 16 cm
(D) 10 cm

Q.4

The population of a city increases 5% annually in compounded manner (yearly compounding). The present population of this city is 93051. The population of this city 2 years ago was:

(A) 84400
(B) 84000
(C) 88000
(D) 88400

Q.5

Asha and Bhuvan can do a piece of work in 6 days and 9 days, respectively. They work on alternate days, starting with Asha on the first day. In how many days will the work be completed?

(A) 6 days
(B) 7 days
(C) 9 days
(D) 8 days

Q.6

The ratio of measures of the angles of a triangle is given as 3 : 4 : 8. What is the measure of the smallest of the three angles?

(A) 33°
(B) 39°
(C) 30°
(D) 36°

Q.9

The marked price of a refrigerator is ₹60,000. A shopkeeper offers a flat discount of ₹12,000 on full cash payment. Further he offers an extra discount of 5% on the marked price to his regular customers. How much does a regular customer have to pay for the refrigerator?

(A) ₹45,000
(B) ₹48,000
(C) ₹44,000
(D) ₹47,000

Q.10

Soham's initial expenditure and savings were in the ratio 5: 1. His income increases by 25%, while his savings increase by 20%. If Soham's current expenditure is ₹4,347, what was his initial income?

(A) ₹4,130
(B) ₹4,140
(C) ₹4,150
(D) ₹4,160

Q.11

A 25% profit is made when a discount of 25% is given on the marked price of an item. When the discount is 35%, what will be the profit? (Give your answer correct to the nearest whole number.)

(A) 13%
(B) 8%
(C) 9%
(D) 11%

Q.12

What is the remainder when 8127 is divided by 8?

(A) 7
(B) 5
(C) 4
(D) 6

Q.17

$8 + [16 - \{7 + 4 - (9 \text{ of } 3 + 6 - 4 \times 7)\}] = ?$

(A) 21
(B) 16
(C) 18
(D) 23

Q.18

If a : b = 2 : 3 and b : c = 6 : 8, then find a : b : c.

(A) 2 : 3 : 5
(B) 2 : 3 : 4
(C) 1 : 2 : 3
(D) 2 : 3 : 6

Q.19

In what ratio must a grocer mix two varieties of pulses costing ₹15 and ₹20 per kg, respectively, so as to get a mixture worth ₹18 per kg?

(A) 3 : 2
(B) 3 : 4
(C) 2 : 3
(D) 2 : 5

Q.20

The average of the first 43 natural numbers is:

(A) 33
(B) 44
(C) 43
(D) 22

Q.21

If $x + y = 14$, then the value of $x^3 + y^3 + 42xy$ is:

(A) 2744 **(B)** 2644

(C) 2742 **(D)** 2714

Q.22

If the length and the breadth of a rectangle are increased by 15% and 20%, respectively, then by how much percent the area of the rectangle will increase?

(A) 32% **(B)** 38%

(C) 36% **(D)** 48%

Q.25

A pen was sold for ₹28.75 at a profit of 15%. If it was sold for ₹25.75, then what would have been the percentage of profit?

(A) 2% **(B)** 3%

(C) 4% **(D)** 1%

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

In animal cells, which membrane-bound cell organelles are generally smaller and help to separate waste products?

(A) Plastids **(B)** Cytosols

(C) Golgi apparatus **(D)** Vacuoles

Q.2

The Men's Hockey World Cup 2023 will be organised by which of the following states?

(A) Uttar Pradesh **(B)** Odisha

(C) Punjab **(D)** Maharashtra

Q.3

Agumbe, a biodiversity-rich region that receives 7640 mm of average annual rainfall in South India, is located in which state?

(A) Andhra Pradesh **(B)** Karnataka

(C) Tamil Nadu **(D)** Kerala

Q.4

What resource is found in sedimentary rocks on the western and eastern flanks of the peninsula in Gujarat?

(A) Gold **(B)** Bauxite

(C) Manganese **(D)** Petroleum

Q.5

‘Sense and Sensibility’, ‘Mansfield Park’ and ‘Emma’ are written by whom among the following authors?

(A) Jane Austen **(B)** Thomas Hardy

(C) George Eliot **(D)** D H Lawrence

Q.6

The 8th T20 Women’s Cricket World Cup will be organised by _____.

(A) India **(B)** England

(C) South Africa **(D)** Australia

Q.7
Famous musician Shakoor Khan was associated with which of the following musical instruments?

(A) Sitar
(B) Sarod
(C) Sarangi
(D) Santoor

Q.8
A candidate seeking election as Vice-President is required to make a security deposit of _____.

(A) ₹25,000
(B) ₹20,000
(C) ₹30,000
(D) ₹15,000

Q.9
Which ecologist's research provided revolutionary new insights into how energy and nutrients move through the ecosystems?

(A) Arthur Tansley
(B) Ernst Haeckel
(C) Charles Elton
(D) Raymond L Lindeman

Q.10
Metabolic reactions in our body are carried out by:

(A) proteins
(B) carbohydrates
(C) lipids
(D) salts

Q.11
Famous classical dancer Vidyagauri Adkar is recognised with _____ Gharana of Indian classical dance form.

(A) Alwar
(B) Gwalior
(C) Banaras
(D) Jaipur

Q.12
Identify the component that is unique only to prokaryotes.

(A) Nucleus
(B) Chromosomes
(C) Mesosome
(D) Nuclear membrane

Q.13
Tansen, one of the well-known musicians of medieval India, was in the court of which of the following Mughal emperors?

(A) Akbar
(B) Aurangzeb
(C) Babur
(D) Humayun

Q.14
Which journalist's autobiography is titled the 'Devil's Advocate: The untold story'?

(A) Vir Sanghvi
(B) Pranoy Roy
(C) Vinod Dua
(D) Karan Thapar

Q.15
In January 2022, which Indian state received a loan of ₹1,000 crores for the protection of social services from the World Bank?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Odisha
(C) West Bengal
(D) Assam

Q.16
Ustad Alla Rakha is famous for his contribution to playing which of the following instruments in Indian Music?

(A) Veena
(B) Ghatam
(C) Tabla
(D) Santoor

Q.17
Guru Shyama Charan Pati, was conferred the Padma Shri for his contributions to mainly which of the following dance forms?

(A) Kathi nacha
(B) Santali dance
(C) Chhau nritya
(D) Jhumair

Q.18
The famous novel 'Pinjar' based on riots during the Indian independence, was written by _____.

(A) Divya Prakash Dubey
(B) Mohan Rakesh
(C) Amrita Pritam
(D) Manav Kaul

Q.19
Identify the plant that shows adaptation through leaves that are reduced to spines.

(A) Mimosa
(B) Rose
(C) Opuntia
(D) Hibiscus

Q.20
Which of the following Hindustani musical Gharanas is the oldest among all the Khayal Gayaki styles?

(A) Agra Gharana
(B) Kirana Gharana
(C) Atrauli Gharana
(D) Gwalior Gharana

Q.21
Which of the following organisations won the Etienne Glichitch Award in May 2021?

(A) Board of Control for Cricket in India
(B) All India Football Federation
(C) Badminton Association of India
(D) Hockey India

Q.22
The title of Asthana Narthaki ('Resident Dancer') was bestowed upon by the Tirumala Tirupathi Devasthanam temple to whom among the following prominent dancer?

(A) Maya Rao
(B) Yamini Krishnamurthy
(C) Sitara Devi
(D) Uma Sharma

Q.23
Banks issue KCC to support credit in agriculture. KCC stands for _____.

(A) Kisan Credit Certificate
(B) Krishi Credit Card
(C) Krishi Credit Certificate
(D) Kisan Credit Card

Q.24
Who among the following Indian Cricketers (Female) won Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award 2021?

(A) Deepti Sharma
(B) Shafali Verma
(C) Poonam Yadav
(D) Mithali Raj

Q.25
Who among the following is the recipient of Sangeet Natak Akademi for Bharatanatyam?

(A) Vijay Shankar
(B) Anita Ratnam
(C) Geeta Chandran
(D) AB Bala Kondala Rao

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**
Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**
Q.15 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**
Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.25 **(B)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (A) as if he had not see

After 'had not' the verb takes its past participle: 'as if he had not seen one before'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) to

One pays a visit 'to' a place: 'A visit to Ladhak is a must these days.'

Q.3 · Answer (D) was set up

To 'set up' an organisation is to establish it, and 'ahead' adds nothing: 'The NCERT was set up by the government'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) for

A period of time takes 'for': 'for two years now'. 'Since' goes with a point in time.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Inflame

To 'incite' is to stir up or provoke: to 'inflame'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) More than thirty-three million people worldwide are watching this match today.

The present continuous passive 'is being watched by' becomes the active 'are watching', with the agent as the subject: 'More than thirty-three million people worldwide are watching this match today.'

Q.7 · Answer (A) Essence

The 'sum and substance' of something is its essence or gist.

Q.8 · Answer (A) CBAD

C introduces pollution as a serious issue, B says it has existed in natural forms since before humans, A turns to the current concern that it is rising, and D names humans and machines as main pollutants: CBAD.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Under pressure

'Under duress' means under pressure or threat.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Very dear

The 'apple of one's eye' is someone very dear to one.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Forthright

A forthright person is direct and outspoken. Fortitude is courage in adversity, and to fortify is to strengthen.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Reality

'Pretence' is a false show; its opposite is 'reality'.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Repitetion

The correct spelling is 'repetition'.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Is Savita joining us for lunch today?

A present continuous question needs 'is' only once, before the subject: 'Is Savita joining us for lunch today?'

Q.16 · Answer (C) Backward

'Precocious' means developed earlier than usual; its opposite is 'backward', slow to develop.

Q.17 · Answer (C) had

'Have a conversation' is the set collocation; 'did' does not go with 'conversation', and 'spoke' and 'talked' do not take it as an object.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Spot

A 'fleck' is a small mark or patch: a 'spot'.

Q.19 · Answer (D) The budget will be announced by the finance minister.

The future active 'will announce' becomes 'will be announced': 'The budget will be announced by the finance minister.'

Q.20 · Answer (D) Heuristic
'Heuristic' describes a method that helps or allows a learner to discover things for themselves.

Q.21 · Answer (A) reflects
Children's well-being 'reflects', that is shows, the health of the society.

Q.22 · Answer (A) bias
'Bias against the female child' is one of the causes of child malnutrition listed.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Besides
'Besides', meaning in addition, adds a second remedy: an effective control over population.

Q.24 · Answer (D) contributory
Ignorance about food is another 'contributory' factor, one that helps cause malnutrition.

Q.25 · Answer (A) menace
To fight the 'menace', the threat or danger, of malnutrition.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (C) 437
Two series alternate: 176, 228, 280, 332 (+52 each) and 218, 291, 364 (+73 each). The next term is 364 + 73 = 437.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 25:8
In 48 : 7, 15 : 4 and 8 : 3 the second number is the square root of one more than the first: √49 = 7, √16 = 4, √9 = 3. For 25 that gives √26, not 8, so 25 : 8 is the odd one.

Q.3 · Answer (D) BJUY
Each letter moves 3 places back: EMXB → BJUY → YGRV → VDOS → SALP.

Q.4 · Answer (B) ×,−,=,×
With ×, −, = and ×: 24 × 6 − 51 = 144 − 51 = 93, and 31 × 3 = 93.

Q.6 · Answer (A) 99
Each number is multiplied by two more than itself: 5 × 7 = 35 and 14 × 16 = 224. Likewise 9 × 11 = 99.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 5,4,3,2,1
In dictionary order: Kind (5), Kinetic (4), Kinship (3), Kitchen (2), Knight (1). 'Kind' comes before 'Kine', 'Kine' before 'Kins', 'Kin' before 'Kit', and 'Ki' before 'Kn'.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 305
The second number is the first times three more than itself, plus 1: 7 × 10 + 1 = 71 and 13 × 16 + 1 = 209. Likewise 16 × 19 + 1 = 305.

Q.10 · Answer (D) 58
Each code is twice the sum of the letters' positions in the alphabet: NOPE = 2 × (14 + 15 + 16 + 5) = 100 and EGG = 2 × (5 + 7 + 7) = 38. So LAP = 2 × (12 + 1 + 16) = 58.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 1365281
Each consonant is written as twice its position in the alphabet and each vowel as its position: S T A T E → 38 40 1 40 5 and E X I L E → 5 48 9 24 5. So A R E N A → 1 36 5 28 1: 1365281.

Q.12 · Answer (D) RESSPROG
The two halves of the word swap places: BIRT HDAY → HDAYBIRT and CHIL DREN → DRENCHIL. So PROG RESS → RESSPROG.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Only conclusion III follow.
Every hut is a house and no villa is a house, so no hut is a villa (III). The buildings that are villas cannot be houses, and nothing says any other building is a hut or a house, so I and II need not follow.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 793
The differences are 11, 12, 8, 35, 19, 144, 108, and each differs from the one before by $+1^3$, -2^2, $+3^3$, -4^2, $+5^3$, -6^2 in turn. The next difference is $108 + 7^3 = 451$, so the term is $342 + 451 = 793$.

Q.15 · Answer (C) ÷,×,−,+, =
With ÷, ×, −, + and =: $16 \div 2 \times 4 - 8 + 10 = 32 - 8 + 10 = 34$.

Q.18 · Answer (C) u v x y t v x t u u y
With u, v, x, y, t, v, x, t, u, u, y in the blanks the block tuuvxxy repeats three times: tuuvxxy tuuvxxy tuuvxxy.

Q.19 · Answer (B) ÷, +, ×, −, =
With ÷, +, ×, − and =: $104 \div 26 + 13 \times 7 - 18 = 4 + 91 - 18 = 77$.

Q.20 · Answer (B) FJHIU
Each letter moves one place forward: THREE → UISFF and SEVEN → TFWFO. So EIGHT → FJHIU.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 1939
Each term is twice the one before plus the next odd number: $58 \times 2 + 1 = 117$, $117 \times 2 + 3 = 237$, $237 \times 2 + 5 = 479$, $479 \times 2 + 7 = 965$, so $965 \times 2 + 9 = 1939$.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 3647
Multiply by 3, 4, 5, 6 and subtract 4, 5, 6, 7: $12 \times 3 - 4 = 32$, $32 \times 4 - 5 = 123$, $123 \times 5 - 6 = 609$, so $609 \times 6 - 7 = 3647$.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (A) 600 m; 72 km/h
The extra 200 m of platform takes 10 more seconds, so the speed is 20 m/s = 72 km/h. In 50 seconds the train covers 1,000 m, its length plus 400 m, so it is 600 m long.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 14 cm
The curved surface area of a hemisphere is $2\pi r^2$: $2 \times 22/7 \times r^2 = 1232$, so $r^2 = 196$ and r = 14 cm.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 84400
Two years ago the population was $93051 \div (1.05)^2 = 93051 \div 1.1025 = 84400$.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 7 days
Asha does 1/6 and Bhuvan 1/9 of the work a day, so each two-day pair does 5/18. After 6 days 15/18 is done, and on day 7 Asha does the remaining 3/18 = 1/6.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 36°
The angles add up to 180°, so the smallest is $3/15 \times 180° = 36°$.

Q.9 · Answer (A) ₹45,000
₹60,000 − ₹12,000 − 5% of ₹60,000 (₹3,000) = ₹45,000.

Q.10 · Answer (B) ₹4,140
With expenditure 5x and savings x, income was 6x. Now income is 7.5x and savings 1.2x, so expenditure is 6.3x = ₹4,347 and x = 690. Initial income = 6×690 = ₹4,140.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 8%
Take the marked price as 100. At 25% off it sells for 75, a 25% profit, so the cost is 60. At 35% off it sells for 65: a profit of 5/60 = 8.33%, about 8%.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 7
$8127 = 8 \times 1015 + 7$, so the remainder is 7. (Only the last three digits matter: $127 = 8 \times 15 + 7$.)

Q.17 · Answer (C) 18
'Of' first: 9 of 3 = 27, so (27 + 6 − 28) = 5; then {7 + 4 − 5} = 6, [16 − 6] = 10 and 8 + 10 = 18.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 2 : 3 : 4
b : c = 6 : 8 = 3 : 4, and b is 3 in both ratios, so a : b : c = 2 : 3 : 4.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 2 : 3
By alligation: (20 – 18) : (18 – 15) = 2 : 3.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 22
The average of 1 to n is (n + 1)/2 = 44/2 = 22.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 2744
$x^3 + y^3 = (x + y)^3 - 3xy(x + y) = 2744 - 42xy$, so $x^3 + y^3 + 42xy = 14^3 = 2744$.

Q.22 · Answer (B) 38%
1.15 × 1.20 = 1.38, so the area increases by 38%.

Q.25 · Answer (B) 3%
Cost price = 28.75 ÷ 1.15 = ₹25. Selling for ₹25.75 gives a profit of ₹0.75, which is 3% of ₹25.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Vacuoles
Vacuoles are membrane-bound storage sacs, small in animal cells and large in plant cells; some store or expel wastes and excess water.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Odisha
The 2023 Men's Hockey World Cup was held in Odisha, at Bhubaneswar and Rourkela.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Karnataka
Agumbe, in the Western Ghats in Karnataka's Shivamogga district, is one of the wettest places in South India.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Petroleum
Petroleum occurs in sedimentary rocks; Gujarat's oil fields, such as Ankleshwar, lie in such basins.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Jane Austen
'Sense and Sensibility', 'Mansfield Park' and 'Emma' are novels by Jane Austen.

Q.6 · Answer (C) South Africa
The eighth ICC Women's T20 World Cup was held in South Africa in February 2023.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Sarangi
Ustad Shakoor Khan, of the Kirana gharana, was one of the leading sarangi players of the twentieth century.

Q.8 · Answer (D) ₹15,000
Under the Presidential and Vice-Presidential Elections Act, 1952, a candidate for Vice-President must deposit ₹15,000, as must a candidate for President.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Raymond L Lindeman
Raymond Lindeman's 1942 paper 'The Trophic-Dynamic Aspect of Ecology' showed how energy flows through an ecosystem's trophic levels.

Q.10 · Answer (A) proteins
Metabolic reactions are catalysed by enzymes, and almost all enzymes are proteins.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Jaipur
Vidyagauri Adkar is a Kathak dancer of the Jaipur gharana.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Mesosome
A mesosome, an infolding of the cell membrane, is found only in prokaryotic cells such as bacteria. A nucleus and nuclear membrane belong to eukaryotes, and both kinds of cell have chromosomes.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Akbar
Tansen was the leading musician at the court of Akbar.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Karan Thapar
'Devil's Advocate: The Untold Story' (2018) is the memoir of the journalist Karan Thapar.

Q.15 · Answer (C) West Bengal
In January 2022 the World Bank approved a $125 million loan (about ₹1,000 crore) to help West Bengal's poor and vulnerable people reach social protection services.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Tabla
Ustad Alla Rakha was a tabla maestro, and the father of the tabla player Zakir Hussain.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Chhau nritya
Guru Shyama Charan Pati of Jharkhand was a leading exponent of the Seraikela style of Chhau.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Amrita Pritam
Amrita Pritam's Punjabi novel 'Pinjar' (1950) is set against the riots of Partition.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Opuntia
In Opuntia, a cactus, the leaves are reduced to spines to cut water loss, and the flattened green stem carries out photosynthesis.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Gwalior Gharana
The Gwalior gharana is the oldest of the khayal gharanas.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Hockey India
In May 2021 the FIH gave Hockey India its Etienne Glichitch Award for its contribution to the growth and development of hockey.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Yamini Krishnamurthy
Yamini Krishnamurthy, the Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi dancer, was made the Asthana Narthaki of the Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanams.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Kisan Credit Card
KCC is the Kisan Credit Card, which gives farmers short-term credit for growing crops.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Mithali Raj
Mithali Raj was among the sportspersons given the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna in 2021.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Geeta Chandran
Geeta Chandran received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for Bharatanatyam for 2016; Anita Ratnam's award that year was for contemporary dance.

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